

HOUSE OF AYURVEDA - BATCH #173

Body Part 1

Three Days Off The Multivitamin (Story VSL)

0:20-3:00 - S01-S43 - stack, accident, labels

Document 4 of 5

Avatar Supplement Graveyard · Solution-Aware

Format Story VSL · ~5:45 · 9:16 vertical · zero lip-sync

Stack Nano Banana Pro / GPT Image → image-to-video

Branch claude/ayurveda-batch-173-vsl-fb061b

Shared VSL body. Runs identically behind Hook A or Hook B. Assumes `GLOBAL_PREFIX` + `GLOBAL_SUFFIX` + `NEG` from the bible on every prompt.

BLOCK 2 — THE PROBLEM (the stack) · 0:20–1:15 · S01–S14

Block intent: build the graveyard by accumulation, then turn it from funny to sad in one shot (`S09`), then make it *cost a marriage a little* (`S12` - `S14`). Cut fast — 2-3s — so the bottles pile up on the viewer the way they piled up on her. Then stop dead at `S14` .

Grade for the whole block: GRADE-A. Flat, cool, desaturated, lifted blacks. Nothing warm until 1:45.

S01 · 0:20–0:25 · 5s

VO: "My bathroom counter had twenty-three bottles on it."

Why: The establishing wide. Give it a full five seconds — this is the shot the viewer measures their own bathroom against. Static and unflinching, like evidence.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L1 — master bathroom. Wide static shot, straight on to the vanity. The entire cream quartz counter is covered with twenty-three supplement bottles of wildly mismatched sizes and colours — white HDPE bottles, two amber glass, a squat blue tub, one enormous cream powder tub, three small brown dropper bottles — crowded in an uneven double row, plus a weekly pill organiser and a glass of water. The woman stands at the far right of frame in her cream cardigan, one hand resting on the counter edge, looking down at them. Warm oak vanity, greige tile, chrome faucet, sheer curtain at a small window camera-left. 35mm, f/4, eye level. Flat cool overcast daylight from camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V)

Locked-off wide, no camera move beyond the faintest handheld breath. She stands still, then lifts one hand and straightens a single bottle by two centimetres — a small pointless tidying gesture — and lowers her hand again. Nothing else moves. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off:** `FOCUS-HANDOFF` — rack from the wide to macro blur on S02.

S02 · 0:25–0:27 · 2s**VO:** "The B-complex,"**IMAGE** — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/2.8. Extreme close-up of a white supplement bottle label filling the frame at a slight angle, printed text clearly legible: "B-COMPLEX 100" in bold above smaller text "HIGH POTENCY · 90 VEGETARIAN CAPSULES". Slight glare across the laminate, one thumbprint smudge. Cream quartz counter, other bottles thrown to soft blur behind. Flat cool window light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Tiny 4cm drift right across the label. Nothing else moves. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** **PAN-THROUGH** — drift continues right into S03.

S03 · 0:27–0:30 · 3s**VO:** "the magnesium I'd switched to glycinate,"

Why: Two magnesium bottles, one shoved aside. "Switched to" is the whole story of her spending — she never stopped buying, she just kept upgrading. Show the abandoned one.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/2.5. Two magnesium bottles side by side on cream quartz. In sharp focus, a newer white bottle reading "MAGNESIUM GLYCINATE 400mg". Behind and shoved sideways at an angle, an older bottle with a faded label reading "MAGNESIUM 500mg", its cap dusty and slightly off. A thin layer of dust visible on the older bottle's shoulder. Flat cool light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Slow 6cm drift right, focus racking gently from the new bottle back to the shoved-aside old one. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — round white cap → round golden capsule.

S04 · 0:30–0:32 · 2s**VO:** "the turmeric with black pepper,"**IMAGE** — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/2.8, overhead. Four mustard-yellow turmeric capsules spilled on cream quartz beside an open bottle lying on its side, one capsule slightly leaking fine orange powder that has stained the counter. A faint orange smear where a thumb wiped at it. Flat cool light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Locked off. One capsule rolls 3cm and stops against another. No other movement. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** **LIGHT-WIPE** — cut on a shadow crossing frame into the fridge-door light of S05.

S05 · 0:32–0:35 · 3s

VO: "the probiotic in the fridge,"

Why: Location break. The fridge shot proves the stack has colonised the whole house, not just one counter. The cold blue fridge light is also a welcome tonal break in a flat grey block.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L2 – kitchen. The refrigerator door open, the woman's hand and forearm reaching into the door shelf, taking hold of a small amber probiotic bottle wedged between a yogurt tub and a milk carton. Her face is out of frame – only arm, hand, and cardigan sleeve. Hard cold blue-white fridge light throws everything else in the dark kitchen into shadow. 35mm, f/2.8, eye level, framed so the lit fridge interior is a bright rectangle in a dark frame. GRADE-A with a cold fridge-light key.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds. Her fingers close on the probiotic bottle and lift it out of the door shelf, out of the top of frame. The milk carton rocks once and settles. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — the bottle exits top of frame; S06 opens with a bottle entering frame.

S06 · 0:35–0:37 · 2s

VO: "the fish oil,"

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/2.2. A wide-mouth bottle of amber fish-oil softgels, cap off, tipped toward camera so we look down into the mass of glossy amber capsules packed inside. Light catches their surfaces in dozens of small highlights. On the counter beside it, two loose softgels. Flat cool light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Slow 5cm push toward the open mouth of the bottle. The highlights on the softgels shift with the move. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** FOCUS-HANDOFF — rack out on the amber gloss, open on soft paper.

S07 · 0:37–0:41 · 4s

VO: "the methylated folate for my MTHFR variant,"

Why: This is the credibility shot for the *type* of person she is — someone who got a genetic test and built a protocol around it. The highlighter on a real-looking report says "I did my homework" better than any line.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W4. L4 – desk nook. Overhead close shot of a printed genetic-test report on the desk, the page headed "METHYLATION PANEL" with a table of rows; one row is highlighted in yellow marker reading "MTHFR C677T – HETEROZYGOUS". The page is dog-eared and has been folded in thirds. A supplement bottle labelled "METHYLFOLATE 1000mcg" sits on the corner of the paper. Her hand rests at the edge of the page, one finger on the highlighted row. 50mm, f/2.8, overhead, slightly angled. Warm desk-lamp pool in an otherwise cool room. GRADE-A with a warm task-light accent.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds overhead. Her fingertip traces slowly along the highlighted row from left to right and stops. Nothing else moves. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — finger drags left-to-right; S08 opens with a scoop dragging left-to-right through powder.

S08 · 0:41–0:45 · 4s

VO: "a collagen tub the size of a paint can,"

Why: The one moment of dry humour in the block. Play the scale absolutely straight — shoot it like a product photo of an industrial container. The joke is that it's real.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L2 – kitchen. Low three-quarter angle across the butcher-block island, hero-lit like a product shot but in flat daylight: an enormous cream-and-gold collagen powder tub, easily 30cm tall, dwarfing the two normal-sized supplement bottles beside it. The lid is off and resting against it, a large plastic scoop buried in the fine off-white powder inside. A dusting of spilled powder on the wood. The woman's hand rests on the rim of the tub for scale. 35mm, f/2.8, low angle so the tub reads as monumental. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Very slow 8cm rise on the camera, making the tub loom slightly. Her hand lifts off the rim and drops out of frame. A little powder dust hangs in the light. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** LIGHT-WIPE — she passes the window; cut inside the shadow.

S09 · 0:45–0:51 · 6s · ♦ LOAD-BEARING SHOT

VO: "the ashwagandha I started after my mother died."

Why: This is the shot that turns the film from a list into a story. Everything before it is inventory; this makes the inventory grief. Do not cut fast. Hold six full seconds and let the music drop out underneath it. The framed photo does all the work — she never has to emote.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W1. L1 – master bathroom, but this shot is on the shelf beside the mirror, not the counter. Close shot: a small brown supplement bottle labelled "ASHWAGANDHA" standing directly beside a modest wooden picture frame holding a slightly faded photograph of an older woman in her seventies, smiling on a porch. The frame glass has a few fingerprints near its lower edge, as though it is picked up often. Deep behind, thrown far out of focus, the woman stands looking at it, her expression unreadable and still. 85mm, f/2.0, focus locked on the frame and the bottle. Flat cool window light camera-left, a soft grey fill. GRADE-A, slightly cooler and more desaturated than surrounding shots.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera holds almost perfectly still, only the faintest handheld breath. Nothing in the frame moves for the first four seconds. Then, deep in the blurred background, she lifts one hand toward her face and lowers it. The focus never leaves the photo frame. 6 seconds.

→ **hands off:** **FOCUS-HANDOFF** — hold the stillness, then cut hard on a rustle of paper into S10. This is the one place a slightly abrupt cut is correct: it's her changing the subject.

S10 · 0:51–0:56 · 5s

VO: "Added up across the year, it was more than four thousand dollars."

Why: Financial proof without a price on screen. Highlighted recurring charges on real-looking statements is the "oh god" beat. **Do not render a total figure** — let the VO own the number, the picture owns the dread.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W4. L2 – kitchen table. Overhead shot of a fan of six or seven printed credit-card statements spread across the table, dozens of line items, many highlighted in yellow – the highlighted rows are all clearly repeat supplement-shop charges. A cheap calculator sits on top of the pile with a number on its display, partially obscured by her hand. Two more statements have been pushed off to the side. Her forearms frame the bottom of the shot. 50mm, f/2.8, overhead. Cool overcast daylight from a window camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds overhead. Her hand slides one statement out of the fan and lays it on top, then her fingers stop and rest flat on the page. She does not pick anything up. 5 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — the rectangle of paper → the rectangle of the bathroom mirror.

S11 · 0:56–1:00 · 4s

VO: "Eight years of religious morning swallowing."

Why: One shot that says "every single morning." Ghosted multiple-exposure of her at the same spot — done subtly, this reads as time passing, not as a gimmick. Keep it at 3–4 ghosts maximum or it turns into a music video.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L1 – master bathroom. The woman standing at the counter in her usual position, shot straight on. Rendered as a subtle in-camera long-exposure multiple exposure: three faint overlapping ghosts of the same woman in slightly different phases of the same routine – reaching for a bottle, tipping pills, raising the glass – layered over one solid sharper version of her at the centre. The counter, bottles and room stay perfectly sharp and solid. Restrained and photographic, not a graphic effect. 35mm, f/4, eye level. Flat cool window light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Camera perfectly locked off. The ghosted layers drift and dissolve slowly into one another while the room stays rock solid. The central figure remains the most solid throughout. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-SHAPE — the solid central figure resolves; S12 opens on her in the same position, same size.

S12 · 1:00–1:06 · 6s

VO: "My husband used to gently ask if I'd ever tried not taking one of them for a while."

Why: He's in the doorway behind her, in the mirror. He is *careful* — hand on the jamb, not entering. Body language does the whole "gently." She doesn't turn around. Two people in one frame, no eye contact between them.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W1. L1 – master bathroom. Medium shot into the vanity mirror. In the mirror we see the woman in the foreground at the counter, mid-routine, glass in hand, not looking up – and behind her, framed in the open doorway, her husband: a man of similar age, grey at the temples, in a plain navy t-shirt, one hand resting on the doorjamb, standing at the threshold and not stepping in. His expression is careful and kind, mouth slightly open as if he has just finished a sentence. She has not turned around. 50mm, f/2.5, eye level. Flat cool window light camera-left, the hallway behind him darker. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera holds with a faint handheld drift. He shifts his weight at the doorway and his hand slides a few centimetres down the jamb. She continues her routine without pausing and without looking up at him in the mirror. Neither one looks at the camera. 6 seconds.

→ **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — she reaches for the cabinet; S13 opens on the cabinet door already moving.

S13 · 1:06–1:10 · 4s

VO: "I told him he didn't understand the stack."

Why: Defensiveness played physically, not facially. She closes the cabinet a little too firmly and keeps her eyes down. That's how people who know they're wrong actually behave.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W1. L1 – master bathroom. Tighter medium shot from the side, three-quarter profile. The woman is pushing the mirrored cabinet door closed with the flat of her hand, jaw set, eyes down and to the side, not looking at the mirror or at the doorway behind her. Her other hand grips the counter edge. In the reflection of the closing cabinet door, the husband's figure sweeps past as the mirror turns. 50mm, f/2.0, eye level, tight. Flat cool light camera-left. GRADE-A, contrast very slightly raised.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds. She pushes the cabinet door shut in one firm movement; the reflection sweeps across the glass as it closes. She keeps her eyes down and does not look up. Her jaw tightens once. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — the door completes its swing; S14 opens on the settled, still room.

S14 · 1:10–1:15 · 5s · ♦ LOAD-BEARING SHOT

VO: "He stopped asking."

Why: The best shot in the first half. Identical framing to S12 — but the doorway is empty. Same room, same light, one person gone. Let the music drop to nothing here. This is the shot that makes a 55-year-old woman text this ad to her sister.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W1. L1 – master bathroom. EXACTLY the same framing, lens, height and lighting as S12 – medium shot into the vanity mirror. The woman is at the counter, glass in hand, alone. The doorway behind her in the mirror is now completely empty; the hallway beyond it is dark. She has stopped mid-routine and is looking into the mirror at the empty doorway behind her own reflection. Her expression is flat and absent, not sad exactly – used to it. 50mm, f/2.5, eye level. Flat cool window light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera holds absolutely still. She does not move for three full seconds, still looking at the empty doorway in the mirror. Then she lowers her eyes, and resumes the routine – she raises the glass and drinks. Nothing else in the room moves at all. She never looks at the camera. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off into Block 3:** **LIGHT-WIPE** — hold two beats of near-silence after the VO, then a headlight sweep crosses the mirror and we cut into the airport block. The silence is the transition.

BLOCK 3 — THE ACCIDENT (re-hook) · 1:15–2:00 · S15–S28

Block intent: re-hook at the 25% drop-off point. Energy lifts, cutting gets faster, and — critically — she never *chooses* to stop taking the supplements. It happens to her. That's what lets the viewer off the hook for their own eight years.

Grade: GRADE-B (cold blue 4am) → warming toward GRADE-E at the sister's house from S28.

S15 · 1:15–1:18 · 3s

VO: "Last May I flew to my sister's for her son's graduation."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. L2 – kitchen. Close shot of a graduation invitation card held to the fridge door by two magnets, printed in navy and gold, legible: "PLEASE JOIN US – CLASS OF 2025 GRADUATION". Around it, a grocery list in ballpoint and a faded strip of family photos. Warm brushed-steel fridge surface. 50mm, f/2.2, slight angle, eye level. Soft cool daylight from the kitchen window camera-right. GRADE-A about to turn.

MOTION (I2V) Slow 6cm push toward the invitation. The card lifts a millimetre at its lower corner as air moves. Nothing else. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-SHAPE — rectangle of card → rectangle of a folded shirt.

S16 · 1:18–1:20 · 2s

VO: "Five days."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L3 – her bedroom. Overhead close shot into an open carry-on suitcase on the bed. Inside, exactly five neatly folded outfits stacked in a row, a zipped toiletry pouch, and a pair of white sneakers tucked at the end. Her hands are pressing the stack down flat. Oatmeal linen bedding around the case. 35mm, f/2.8, overhead. Flat cool daylight. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds overhead. Both her hands press the folded stack down twice, firmly, then withdraw out of frame. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — hands withdraw; S17 opens with a hand pushing *into* a bag.

S17 · 1:20–1:25 · 5s

VO: "At 4am at the airport I realized I'd left the entire supplement bag"

Why: The realisation, played on the body. If you're running Hook B, shoot this as a **tighter, different angle** than H2-01 so it doesn't read as a repeat — go to the hands and the shoulders, skip the wide.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W3. L5 — airport concourse, 4am, deserted. Medium-tight shot from a low three-quarter angle. The woman stopped mid-stride, her hand pushed deep into an open tan crossbody bag, feeling around. Her carry-on has rolled slightly ahead of her. She is looking down and away, mouth just parted, brow tightening. Cold overhead fluorescents, a warm sodium spill from a distant lit newsstand. Empty concourse blurred deep behind her. 50mm, f/2.0, slightly below eye level. GRADE-B: cold blue-grey, deep shadows.

MOTION (I2V)

Slow 10cm push in. Her hand searches the bag twice more and then goes completely still. Her shoulders drop. She closes her eyes for one full beat and opens them. The carry-on handle tips and settles. She never looks at the camera. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off:** **LIGHT-WIPE** — a blurred traveller crosses foreground; cut inside the blur.

S18 · 1:25–1:27 · 2s

VO: "on my kitchen counter."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. L2 — kitchen at 4am, unlit. The quilted grey canvas supplement bag sits alone on the butcher-block island, half-unzipped, bottles visible inside. Deep darkness all around, white cabinets reading grey-blue. One thin band of streetlight through the window falls across the bag itself. 35mm, f/2.8, low eye-level across the island. GRADE-B.

MOTION (I2V) **Locked off. Absolutely nothing moves. The band of streetlight is perfectly still. Dead air. 2 seconds.** → **hands off:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — the lit band across the bag → a lit band across her face in S19.

S19 · 1:27–1:30 · 3s

VO: "I almost turned around."

IMAGE — GPT Image

W3. L5 – airport. Close shot of the woman from behind and slightly to the side, her head turned back over her shoulder, looking down the concourse toward the distant exit signs. We see three-quarters of her face in profile, lit on one side by a hard cold fluorescent band. Her hand still on the luggage handle. Real indecision – the head is turned but the feet have not moved. 85mm, f/2.0, just behind her shoulder. GRADE-B.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds tight behind her shoulder with a faint float. She holds the look back for two seconds, then turns her head slowly forward again. Her hand stays on the handle. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — head turns forward; S20 opens on her already seated, facing forward.

S20 · 1:30–1:34 · 4s

VO: "I knew what happened to my body when I missed even one morning."

Why: Anticipatory dread, played as a physical gesture: the flat hand pressed to the sternum. Universally readable, never cheesy, and it costs nothing.

IMAGE — GPT Image

W3. L5 – airport gate seating, empty rows either side of her. The woman sitting alone, leaning slightly forward, elbows on knees, the flat of one hand pressed against her sternum. She is looking at the floor. Her bag is on the seat beside her. Rows of empty blue seats recede behind. Cold overhead fluorescents from directly above, casting shadow into her eye sockets. 50mm, f/2.2, eye level from across the aisle. GRADE-B.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds from across the aisle with a slow handheld float. She takes one deliberate deep breath – her shoulders rise and fall – and her hand presses a little harder against her chest. She keeps looking at the floor. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-SHAPE — cut on the overhead light bar to the lit departures board.

S21 · 1:34–1:36 · 2s

VO: "The plane was boarding."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people in focus. L5 – airport gate. Low-angle shot of an overhead departures monitor, the screen legible: a flight row with the status "BOARDING" in amber. Beneath it, out of focus, the shapes of a queue forming and a gate agent's arm scanning. Cold fluorescent light with amber screen spill. 50mm, f/2.0, focus on the screen. GRADE-B with amber accents.

MOTION (I2V) Locked off. The BOARDING text on the screen blinks once. Blurred figures shuffle forward in the lower frame. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** PAN-THROUGH — the queue moves right; S22 opens with her walking right.

S22 · 1:36–1:41 · 5s

VO: "I told myself I'd buy replacements at the airport, and I didn't."

Why: One of the best shots in the film and almost nobody would think of it: she walks *past* a lit airport shop wall of vitamins without stopping. The choice is shown by the not-stopping. Track with her so the shelf slides by behind her and out of frame — the temptation physically leaves.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W3. L5 – airport newsstand at 4am. Tracking medium shot from the side as the woman walks right to left past the open shopfront, carry-on in tow. Behind her, brightly lit under retail LEDs, a full shelf wall of travel-sized vitamins, multivitamin bottles and electrolyte sachets – the only saturated colour in the frame. She is looking straight ahead down the concourse, not at the shelf. Her face is calm, almost blank. 35mm, f/2.8, eye level, she stays centre-frame while the shelf slides behind her. GRADE-B, with the retail shelf noticeably brighter and warmer than everything around it.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera tracks smoothly sideways with her at walking pace, keeping her centred while the lit vitamin shelf slides across the background right to left and out of frame behind her. She walks at a steady pace and does not turn her head or slow down. Her eyes stay forward. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off:** PAN-THROUGH — the lateral move continues into S23, which opens still drifting sideways.

S23 · 1:41–1:43 · 2s

VO: "Day one, nothing."

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W3. L6 – sister's guest room. The woman sitting on the edge of the guest bed, still in her travel clothes, shoes on, suitcase unopened on the floor. She is just sitting, hands in her lap, looking at nothing. Dated floral wallpaper border, patterned quilt. Flat late-afternoon light through a half-closed blind, striping the wall. 35mm, f/2.8, eye level from the doorway. GRADE-B, very slightly warmer than the airport.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds from the doorway. She sits completely still, then blinks and looks down at her own hands. Nothing else moves. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-SHAPE — cut on the round bedside lamp base to the round clock face.

S24 · 1:43–1:46 · 3s

VO: "Day three, I woke up at 7am."

Why: If you ran Hook A or B, the viewer has already seen the 7:04 clock. **Good** — this is the payoff of a plant. But change the angle: go tight on the clock alone first, then her. Repetition with variation is what makes a VSL feel authored.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people in focus. L6 – sister's guest room. Macro close-up of a small brass alarm clock on a wooden nightstand, its face legible at 7:04. A hard band of warm morning sun falls diagonally across the clock face and the wood grain. Deep behind and completely out of focus, the shape of the woman under a patterned quilt. 100mm macro, f/2.0, focus locked on the clock. GRADE-E: warm morning daylight, open shadows, gentle saturation.

MOTION (I2V) Slow 5cm push toward the clock. The second hand sweeps. Behind, in soft blur, the quilt shifts as she stirs. Focus stays on the clock. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** FOCUS-HANDOFF — rack from the clock back to her, then cut.

S25 · 1:46–1:48 · 2s

VO: "I'd gone to bed at 11."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. L6 – sister's guest room at night. The identical brass alarm clock in the identical framing as the previous shot, but at night and reading 11:02. A bedside lamp is being switched off – the frame is half-lit warm and half in darkness. A paperback lies face down beside the clock. 100mm macro, f/2.0. Warm tungsten falling to black. GRADE-D warmth, low key.

MOTION (I2V) Locked-off, identical framing to the previous clock shot. The lamp light goes out during the shot and the frame drops to near-darkness, the clock face just readable. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-SHAPE — identical clock framing, day/night flip. The match itself is the edit.

S26 · 1:48–1:51 · 3s

VO: "I had slept the whole night."

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W2. L6 – sister's guest room. The woman sitting up in bed, one hand flat on the quilt beside her, hair slept-on, pillow crease on her cheek. She is looking down at her own hand, not at anything. Her expression is bewildered, not happy – eyebrows slightly raised, mouth closed. Broad warm morning sun across the bed and the wall behind her. 50mm, f/2.0, camera at mattress height. GRADE-E.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds at mattress height. She looks down at her hand, then slowly lifts her eyes and looks toward the window. She takes one full breath. She does not smile. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** LIGHT-WIPE — the warm sun blooms out to white; cut hard into the cold black of S27.

S27 · 1:51–1:56 · 5s · CONTRAST

VO: "I'd been falling asleep at midnight and waking at 3am for two straight years."

Why: The airless overhead insomnia shot. Coldest, flattest, stillest frame in the entire film — it should feel like the temperature drops. Five seconds of nothing moving is a long time; that's the point.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W2. L3 — her own bedroom, deep night. Overhead shot from directly above the bed, straight down. The woman flat on her back on oatmeal linen, both eyes wide open, staring straight up past the camera, absolutely still. Her phone lies face-up on the duvet beside her hand, its screen the only light, throwing hard cold blue-white up onto her chin, cheekbones and brow and leaving her eye sockets in shadow. The screen reads 3:12. The rest of the room is near-black. 35mm, f/2.8, directly overhead. Very cold, very flat, crushed blacks.

MOTION (I2V) Locked-off overhead, no camera move whatsoever. She does not move at all except for one slow blink at second three. The phone screen dims one step. Airless stillness. 5 seconds. → **hands off:**

LIGHT-WIPE — the phone screen times out to black; hold black for 6 frames; open S28 in warm daylight. The black gap is the time-jump.

S28 · 1:56–2:00 · 4s

VO: "Day five my sister said, 'I don't want to tell you what to do, but you look better than you have in three years.'"

Why: First external validation and the **first genuine warmth in the film's grade**. Play it as two women at a kitchen table mid-conversation — the sister looking at her a beat too long is the whole line.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W3 (vest off, sage tee only). L6 – sister's kitchen. Two-shot across a small kitchen table, morning. The woman sits with a coffee mug in both hands. Across from her, her sister – a similar-aged woman with darker hair, in a robe – has stopped mid-motion, mug halfway down, and is openly studying her face. Warm morning sun through a window behind them, dated oak cabinets, a fruit bowl. The woman is registering the compliment and slightly deflecting, eyes dropping to her mug. 50mm, f/2.2, eye level from the end of the table so both are in frame. GRADE-E: warm, open, gently saturated – noticeably warmer than anything before it.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera holds at the end of the table with a soft handheld float. The sister sets her mug down and keeps looking at her. The woman glances up, meets her eyes for a beat, then looks back down into her own mug and lifts one shoulder in a small dismissive shrug. Neither smiles broadly. Neither looks at the camera. 4 seconds.

→ **hands off into Block 4:** **FOCUS-HANDOFF** — rack to the window light behind them until white, then open S29 on a cool doorway. Warmth out, cold back in — she's home.

BLOCK 4 — THE LABELS + INVALIDATION · 2:00–2:50 · S29–S43

Block intent: the mechanism block. This is where a solution-aware viewer gets the *specific, checkable* reason their current solution failed. Everything here must look like evidence: hard task light, macro text, documents, shallow focus. Cutting tightens to 2–4s. She has her glasses **on** for this entire block — that's the visual signal she has switched from believer to investigator.

Grade: GRADE-C. One warm pool of task light, room falling to black, contrast up.

S29 · 2:00–2:04 · 4s

VO: "I flew home and Monday morning I stood at my counter"

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W1. L1 – master bathroom, seen from the hallway. The woman standing in the bathroom doorway, arms folded, shot from behind and to one side so we read her posture and the back of her head. Beyond her, the counter and its row of bottles in cool window light. She is completely still. The hallway around the camera is dark, framing the bright doorway. 35mm, f/2.8, eye level, strong frame-within-a-frame. GRADE-A returning to flat and cool.

MOTION (I2V) Very slow 12cm push forward through the dark hallway toward the lit doorway. She does not move at all. The bottles grow slightly in frame. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** PAN-THROUGH — the push continues into S30 at the same rate.

S30 · 2:04–2:08 · 4s

VO: "and asked which of those twenty-three bottles had been making me worse."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W1. L1 – master bathroom. Low camera at counter height, looking straight down the long row of supplement bottles receding into frame. The nearest bottles razor sharp, labels facing every direction. Deep behind and fully out of focus, the woman stands with her arms folded. 50mm, f/1.8, focus locked on the nearest bottle. Flat cool window light camera-left. GRADE-A.

MOTION (I2V) Slow continuous 12cm dolly along the row. Focus begins to rack toward her blurred figure and stops before resolving – she never comes sharp. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — a hand enters frame and takes the nearest bottle.

S31 · 2:08–2:11 · 3s · TONE SHIFT

VO: "So I started reading labels."

Why: The glasses coming *down* onto her face is the single gesture that flips the film from victim to investigator. Shoot it tight and let it be the whole shot.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W4. L1 – master bathroom. Tight close-up, three-quarter profile. The woman is pulling her tortoiseshell reading glasses down from the top of her head onto her nose with one hand, while the other hand holds a supplement bottle up at chest height. Her eyes are already dropping toward the label. Focused, slightly hard expression – no softness. 85mm, f/2.0, eye level. The flat window light is now joined by a warmer, harder task light from camera-right. GRADE-C beginning: contrast rising, one warm key.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds tight. She pulls the glasses down onto her nose in one movement and settles them with a small push at the bridge. Her eyes drop to the label in her other hand and lock there. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — her eyeline drops; S32 opens on what she's looking at.

S32 · 2:11–2:16 · 5s · ♦ THE MECHANISM

VO: "My multivitamin used magnesium oxide,"

Why: The shot that makes people pause the ad and go check their own bottle. The text must be perfectly legible. Nano Banana Pro renders this reliably — spell the string exactly and generate 4 variants until the panel is clean. Do not let this be soft or stylised.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/3.5. Extreme close-up of a Supplement Facts panel on the back of a white multivitamin bottle, filling the frame, shot dead flat so the text is fully sharp edge to edge. The panel is legible with clear black text on white: a "Supplement Facts" header, a rule, and rows including "Vitamin D3 25mcg", then a clearly readable row "Magnesium (as Magnesium Oxide) 250mg", then "Zinc (as Zinc Oxide) 15mg". The magnesium row sits in the centre of frame. Slight curvature of the bottle at the frame edges, a faint laminate glare in one corner, one small thumbprint. Hard warm task light from camera-right raking across, deep shadow at the frame edge. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V)

Extremely slow 4cm push toward the "Magnesium (as Magnesium Oxide)" row, which stays perfectly sharp and legible for the entire shot. The bottle is held steady in an unseen hand with the faintest human tremor. No focus change. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — the bottle begins to rotate; S33 opens continuing the rotation.

S33 · 2:16–2:19 · 3s

VO: "the cheap alkaline form."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W4. 100mm macro, f/2.5. Close on her hand rotating the multivitamin bottle slowly, her thumb dragging across the printed label as she turns it. Focus on her thumb and the label edge. Her face is out of frame. Chipped neutral nail polish, one gold wedding band, dry skin at the knuckle. Hard warm task light from camera-right, dark background. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds macro. Her thumb drags slowly across the label from left to right, rotating the bottle about 40 degrees. The movement is slow and deliberate. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-ACTION** — rotation completes; S34 opens with the bottle being set down.

S34 · 2:19–2:22 · 3s

VO: "I knew it absorbed poorly."

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W4. L1 – master bathroom. Medium close-up, three-quarter. The woman lowering the bottle to the counter, glasses on, eyes still on it as she sets it down. Her jaw is tight and her mouth is a hard flat line. Not surprised yet – irritated. 50mm, f/2.0, eye level. Hard warm task light from camera-right, the rest of the room falling into shadow. GRADE-C: high contrast, warm key, cool ambient.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds. She sets the bottle down on the counter with a small deliberate press, and her fingers stay on the cap for a beat before releasing. Her jaw tightens. She does not look up. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** **LIGHT-WIPE** — she passes the task lamp; cut inside the shadow into the night desk.

S35 · 2:22–2:28 · 6s

VO: "What I didn't know is your kidneys actively work to flush it,"

Why: The research beat. Late night, one lamp, glasses reflecting the screen. This is where "she found out something you don't know" gets established. Keep the on-screen text generic — a study abstract, not a brand.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W4. L4 – desk nook, late night, room otherwise dark. Medium close-up from the side and slightly behind, so we see her face in three-quarter and the laptop screen glow on it. The screen shows a plain academic journal abstract page – dense grey body text, one line highlighted. Her reading glasses catch the screen as two small rectangles of light. Her finger is on the trackpad. A green desk lamp is the only other light. 50mm, f/2.0, eye level. GRADE-C: single warm key, deep black surround, cool screen fill.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera holds with a faint handheld float. She scrolls the page slowly with two fingers on the trackpad; the text on screen moves upward. She stops scrolling abruptly and leans about five centimetres closer to the screen. Her eyes narrow. 6 seconds.

→ **hands off:** **MATCH-ACTION** — she leans in; S36 opens on the document she leans toward.

S36 · 2:28–2:33 · 5s · ◆ PROOF SHOT

VO: "so you can test low for magnesium even while you take it every day."

Why: **The most persuasive single frame in the invalidation block.** A blood panel flagged LOW sitting next to the bottle she's been taking daily. Two objects, one contradiction, zero explanation needed.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. L4 – desk. Overhead close shot of a printed blood-test result sheet on the desk, a clean clinical table of rows. One row is clearly legible and flagged: "Magnesium, Serum – 1.6 mg/dL – LOW" with the word "LOW" in bold beside a reference range. Lying directly on top of the paper, at the edge of frame, is the same white multivitamin bottle from earlier, its "Magnesium (as Magnesium Oxide)" label edge just readable. Warm desk-lamp pool falling off to darkness at the frame edges. 50mm, f/2.8, overhead. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Very slow 6cm push toward the flagged "LOW" row. The paper lifts a millimetre at one corner. No hands enter the frame. The text stays perfectly sharp and legible throughout. 5 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — the white bottle at frame edge → the same bottle held over the bin.

S37 · 2:33–2:38 · 5s

VO: "I'd been taking the exact form my body was built to throw away, for eight years,"

Why: She holds the bottle over the trash can — and doesn't let go. The hesitation is the emotion. Eight years of belief doesn't drop out of your hand in one second.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W4. L1 — master bathroom. Medium shot from the side. The woman standing with her arm extended, holding the white multivitamin bottle out over an open stainless bin, hand suspended. She has not let go. She is looking at the bottle, glasses on, mouth slightly open. The bin is dark and open beneath her hand. 50mm, f/2.2, eye level from her side. Hard warm task light from camera-right, deep shadow beneath. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds from her side. Her hand stays suspended over the bin for three full seconds without releasing. Her fingers tighten slightly instead of opening. Then she draws the bottle back toward her chest. She does not drop it. 5 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — the bottle comes back toward her; S38 opens on a document at chest height.

S38 · 2:38–2:42 · 4s

VO: "while my naturopath kept raising the dose."

Why: The escalating dose card is a quietly devastating prop. Crossed-out numbers going up show a professional doubling down on a failing input — the viewer's whole experience of their own protocol, in one piece of paper.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/2.8. Close on a small handwritten practitioner dosage card lying on the counter, blue ballpoint on a printed clinic notecard. A dosage line has been revised three times, each earlier figure struck through: "200mg" crossed out, "400mg" crossed out, "600mg daily" circled. The handwriting is a real clinician's quick scrawl, slightly different pen pressure on each revision. A paperclip mark dents one corner. Hard warm task light raking from camera-right. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Very slow 5cm drift down the card past the crossed-out figures to the circled "600mg daily". The handwriting stays perfectly sharp and legible. No hands. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — a forearm sweeps into frame.

S39 · 2:42–2:45 · 3s

VO: "That was the thread that unraveled the whole stack."

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W4. L1 – master bathroom. Overhead wide of the counter. Both her forearms sweep in from the bottom of frame, gathering a dozen supplement bottles toward her in one movement. Bottles tip and knock against each other. Her face is not in frame – only forearms, cardigan sleeves pushed to the elbow, and the chaos of bottles. 35mm, f/4, directly overhead. Hard warm task light from camera-right, high contrast. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Locked-off overhead. Both forearms sweep in decisively from the bottom of frame and drag a cluster of bottles toward the camera. Several bottles tip over and roll. The movement is fast and committed, not gentle. 3 seconds. → **hands off:** WHIP-BY — a bottle tumbles across the lens; cut at maximum blur.

S40 · 2:45–2:47 · 2s

VO: "The B-vitamins were synthetic."

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. 100mm macro, f/3.5. Extreme close-up of an ingredient line on a supplement label, dead flat and perfectly legible: "Vitamin B12 (as Cyanocobalamin) 1000mcg". The word "Cyanocobalamin" sits centre-frame. Slight laminate glare at one edge. Hard warm task light raking from camera-right. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Locked off with the faintest hand tremor on the held bottle. No camera move. The text stays sharp and legible. 2 seconds. → **hands off:** MATCH-ACTION — cut to a cap being twisted off.

S41 · 2:47–2:51 · 4s

VO: "The fish oil failed a sniff test the moment I actually smelled it."

Why: Sensory shots punch above their weight — the viewer *smells* this. The recoil is small and involuntary, not comic. Never play it broad.

IMAGE — *GPT Image*

W4. L1 – master bathroom. Close-up, three-quarter. The woman has just brought the open fish-oil bottle up near her face and is pulling her head back and away from it, chin tucking, nose wrinkling, eyes narrowing – a small involuntary recoil, not a comic reaction. Her other hand still holds the cap. Glasses on. 85mm, f/2.0, eye level. Hard warm task light from camera-right. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Camera holds tight. She lifts the open bottle toward her nose, then pulls her head back sharply about fifteen centimetres, turning her face away and to the side. Her nose wrinkles. She holds the bottle at arm's length. Small and involuntary, not exaggerated. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-ACTION** — the arm extends away; S42 opens with a bottle dropping into a bag.

S42 · 2:51–2:55 · 4s

VO: "I'd been treating the smoke for eight years,"

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

W4. L1 – master bathroom. Overhead shot looking down into the open mouth of a black plastic trash bag being held open on the counter. Bottles are falling into it – three in mid-air, a dozen already at the bottom of the bag. Her hand grips the bag's rim at the edge of frame. The bag mouth is a black void filling most of the frame. 35mm, f/2.8, directly overhead. Hard warm task light from camera-right, the bag interior in deep black. GRADE-C.

MOTION (I2V) Locked-off overhead. Three bottles drop into the bag one after another and disappear into the black. The bag rim shifts in her grip. The bag mouth wobbles slightly. 4 seconds. → **hands off:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — the black void of the bag → the dark doorway beside the counter in S43.

S43 · 2:55–3:00 · 5s · ♦ LOAD-BEARING SHOT

VO: "and half of what I was swallowing was feeding the fire."

Why: The bare counter with twenty-three ring-marks in the dust. This is the payoff of the entire first half — the absence, plus the physical evidence of how long they sat there. It's the single most shareable frame in the film. Hold five seconds and let the music breathe out.

IMAGE — *Nano Banana Pro*

No people. L1 – master bathroom. Wide static shot, straight on to the vanity, matched exactly to the framing of S01. The counter is now completely bare – and the cream quartz is covered in twenty-plus faint circular dust rings and dried water marks where the bottles stood, arranged in the same uneven double row. A tied black trash bag slumps on the floor at the edge of frame by the door. The mirror reflects an empty room. 35mm, f/4, eye level. Flat cool window light from camera-left. GRADE-A returning: flat, cool, quiet.

MOTION (I2V)

Camera perfectly locked off, matched to the S01 framing. Absolutely nothing moves in the frame for the entire duration except a slow drift of dust motes through the window light. No people enter. Complete stillness. 5 seconds.

→ **hands off into Block 5:** **MATCH-SHAPE** — one dust ring on the counter → the ring-stain under the plastic bottle on the desk. Same shape, new suspect. This is the pivot of the entire VSL.

→ **continues in** **04-BODY-PART-2.md** **(S44-S80)**